

ENG 101
Lesson - 40
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1. Your paraphrase may contain some words from the original passage but try to use **synonyms** wherever possible.

2. Change direct quotations to indirect quotations - i.e. use **reported speech**.

3. Change **active** sentences to **passive** sentences and **vice versa**.

Step 1. Read the passage carefully a number of times till you understand it fully.

Step 2. Look up words that you do not understand in a dictionary. Try to find synonyms for them.

Step 3. Jot down the main points of the passage.

Step 4. Make an outline of the with the help of the points you have jotted.

Remember your outline should contain

- a The main idea
- b. the main supporting ideas or points
- c. the primary and secondary supporting details

Step 5. Write the paraphrase using your own words without omitting any essential idea.

Step 6. Polish the paraphrase.

Practice 1:

It is said that when in 1998 Brazil lost the World Cup to France the Brazilians were so disheartened that one had the impression that a big national disaster had taken place and the country itself had died. They say that many did die of sadness. Defeat in

championship matches has often caused heart attacks and the despair of the public is usually so great that many take their own lives. Such is the passion of football fans.

Outline A Brazil lost World Cup 1998

1. Entire country sad
2. Some deaths

B Possible defeat causes strong reaction

1. Heart attacks
2. Suicides

C Football fans very emotional.

Paraphrase In 1998 Brazil lost the World Cup to France. The entire country was overcome with sadness; some people even died. Defeat in championship matches cause strong reaction among fans from heart attacks to even suicides. Football fans are very emotional about the game.

Practice 2:

‘The best approach to students’ co-operation is the organization of **thrift** societies. The principle of **thrift** is as important from the co-operative as it is from the educational point of view. Thrift gives a basic foundation to character and it is easy to form this habit in one’s early life. In the process of the formation of this habit the young student will have to exercise **rigorous** self-discipline, which will not only have a great effect on his own spiritual life, but will react on his family, and through the family on society as a whole.

Words: Thrift = saving, economy.

Rigorous = firm, demanding, strict.

Outline: How students can best cooperate -- thrift societies -- threefold value of thrift -- foundation of character -- formation of habits -- exercise of strict disciplines -- effect of thrift -- its deeper influence, spiritually and financially.

Practice 3.

Each of us is here for a brief **sojourn**; for what purpose he knows not, though he sometimes thinks he feels it. But from the point of view of daily life, without going deeper, we exist for our fellowmen ---in the first place for those on depends, and next for all those unknown to us personally with whose **destinies** we are bound up by the tie of sympathy. A hundred times every day I remind myself that my inner and outer life depends on the labors of other men, living and dead, and that I must **exert** myself in order to give in the same **measure** as I have received and am still receiving. - *Albert Einstein*

Sojourn = stay, rest, stopover, visit

destiny = lives, fate, fortunes

exert = effort, apply

measure = amount, portion, share

Outline : Our life brief -- purpose unknown-- but simply felt -- our immediate relation first to those with whom we are intimate, then to those we are allied with by sympathy -- the dependence of my life on the labor of the living and the dead -- feel the duty of give and take,

Practice 4 :

Paraphrase the following passage. Follow the steps given earlier.

Kaleem Omar, the journalist, has studied Japanese business customs and habits. He says that the Japanese prefer to work collectively as members of groups rather than individually. This, he says is one of the main reasons for Japan's economic success.

Outline.

A. Reported that Japanese work in groups not as individual.

B. This reason for Japanese economic success.

Paraphrase: K. Omar the journalist says that the Japanese like to work together in groups and not singly. He believes that this feature is one of the most important factors responsible for Japanese economic success.

PRACTICE 5: POEM

Lives of great men all remind us
We can make our lives **sublime**,
And departing leave behind us
Footprints on the sands of time,
Footprints that perhaps another,
Sailing o'er life's **solemn main**,
A **forlorn** and shipwrecked brother,
Seeing, shall take heart again.

(i) Substituting other words: **sublime**— lofty , exalted, eminent, grand, noble-**forlorn**- abandoned, deserted, friendless, **solemn** - serious, sober, grave
main - (obs.) open sea

(ii) The **central idea** in the above lines is that the ***lives of all great men remind us of certain duties***

(iii) Removing the inversions and rewriting the sentences in the same order and we have:

Outline We may make our lives great--- Departing, we may leave behind us footprints on the sands of time---There may be footprints which may be seen by a shipwrecked brother and may help him to take heart again.

Paraphrase :

The lives of all great men remind us that we also may live (make) noble

(sublime) lives and that, when we die (departing) we may leave records of our actions (footprints) in this world (sands of time) like the marks of footsteps left by travelers on the sands of the seashore. These records (foot prints) may be noticed by some unfortunate person (a shipwrecked brother) who has no one to guide him (forlorn) and may encourage him (to take heart) in his distress or sorrow.

iv) **Polishing**: the paraphrase may be written as:

The lives of all great men inspire us so that we also may live noble lives, and that, when we die, we may leave behind us records of our noble deeds like the marks of footprints left by a traveler on the sands of the sea shore. These records may, by chance, be read by some unfortunate person who having made a wreck of his life is in the grip of despair, and this may give him fresh encouragement in his loneliness and misery to make a new start in life.

PRACTICE 6:

News Item

Karachi APP – Rescue workers located the body of a New Karachi teenager on the beach at Clifton, one day after a sand bar where he was walking with his friends washed out in the rising tide. Police sources said the body of Mohammad Irfan, 15, was recovered on the beach on Sunday morning. The body was found 2½ miles away from the area where he fell about 6:15 pm. Saturday afternoon. The boy and his friend, Ali Zaman, were walking on the sand bar with other teens when the sand washed out from under them, said the victim's mother, Zainab Khatoon. Passers-by pulled Ali Zaman to safety, witnesses said.

Paraphrase:

On Sunday the body of a young man who was drowned while walking on a sand bar washed away by the tide, was discovered at Clifton beach on Saturday afternoon. His friend who was with him at the time of the accident had been rescued by passers – by.

Some more examples of paraphrase.

We have just enough religion to make us hate, but not enough to make us love one another. (Swift)

Our religious is not of the true kind, for we act in just the opposite way of its teaching.

The narrowest hinge on my hand puts to scorn all machinery. (W. Whitman)

- The smallest joint in the bones of my hand is a far more wonderful thing than any machinery.

The main argument in favor of keeping the death penalty for murder is that it will frighten men out of the

desire to commit the crime. In other words it will act as a preventive.

The main argument for retaining capital punishment for murder is that it will act as a deterrent.

There are no gains without pains; then help, hands, for I have no lands, or if I have, they are smartly taxed. (Benjamin Franklin)

- Nothing can be earned without labour, so set to work, my hands, for what land I have is heavily taxed.

i) No man is so void of understanding as to prefer war before peace; for in the latter children bury their fathers; in the former, fathers bury their children.

- No man would be so stupid as to prefer war over peace; for in peace the young bury the old, while in war the old bury the young who die fighting in war.

vi) Applicants are requested to state the reasons for any exceptional treatment they require.

(NOTICE AT A HOSPITAL)

- Applicants should state why they need special treatment.

All drivers and visitors to the hospital are strictly forbidden to park in or on the verge of the road.

Attention is drawn to the fact that a public car park is available in Millat Street.

No parking on this road. Use the park in Millat Street.

Civil personnel will halt here and report their presence at the guard room. They will on no account proceed further till vetted and granted clearance by the security officer on duty. Offenders are warned that

any failure to observe these regulations will result in detention and prosecution.

- All civilians will report at the guard room for permission to enter. Offenders will be prosecuted. In cases where the school day is terminated earlier than the normal time owing to the necessity to get pupils home before the onset of monsoon rains, a careful note of the relevant circumstances must be made and transmitted to the Education Office at the earliest possible opportunity.

In case the school day is shortened owing to monsoon rains, the Education Office must be informed immediately . /

The Education Office must be informed as soon as possible if monsoon rains make it necessary to end school earlier than usual.

You looked at different samples of paraphrases – single sentences, short prose passages, a poem, and a news item.

Paraphrasing takes time. It cannot be done hastily.

2. In a paraphrase on no account must you introduce anything which is **not** in the original however much you may wish or want to; that you can do in an essay but not in a paraphrase.

3. Don't try to change every word of the original. Some words **cannot** be suitably replaced.

4. A paraphrase is neither an expansion nor a summary.

5. No introducing sentence is needed to begin it.

